



Commercial Lease Abstraction Checklist

126 fields. Every clause. Nothing missed.

Section 1 - Parties & Property

- ☐ Verify landlord legal entity name matches signature block exactly
- ☐ Verify tenant legal entity name and state of formation
- ☐ Confirm premises address, building name, floor, and suite number
- ☐ Record total rentable square footage and method of measurement (BOMA, usable, etc.)
- ☐ Identify all guarantors and confirm guaranty type (full, partial, burn-down)

Section 2 - Lease Term & Key Dates

- ☐ Record commencement date and confirm against possession or occupancy certificate
- ☐ Record expiration date and calculate total term length
- ☐ Note any landlord contingencies that could delay commencement
- ☐ Extract rent commencement date (may differ from commencement date)
- ☐ Record all renewal option exercise deadlines with required notice periods
- ☐ Flag any date tied to a "going dark" or co-tenancy trigger

Section 3 - Base Rent & Escalations

- ☐ Extract base rent for each lease year in \$/SF/year and \$/month
- ☐ Identify escalation type: fixed step, CPI, percentage over base
- ☐ For CPI escalations: note index, cap, floor, and calculation date
- ☐ For fixed steps: tabulate every rent step through lease expiration
- ☐ Confirm free rent periods, abatements, and their conditions for claw-back
- ☐ Note any percentage rent provision and natural breakpoint calculation
- ☐ Flag any rent reconciliation or true-up obligations

Section 4 - Operating Expenses & CAM

- ☐ Identify gross, modified gross, NNN, or full-service lease structure
- ☐ Extract estimated CAM pass-through amount and reconciliation frequency
- ☐ Identify all exclusions from operating expenses (capital, management fee cap, etc.)
- ☐ Note any CAM cap: cumulative or year-over-year, controllable vs. total
- ☐

- ☐ Record admin/management fee percentage and whether it applies to all expenses
- ☐ Confirm tenant's pro-rata share and calculation method (leased vs. total vs. occupied)

Section 5 - Tenant Improvements & Allowances

- ☐ Extract TI allowance amount (\$/SF or lump sum)
- ☐ Note TI outside date and consequences of missing deadline
- ☐ Identify landlord work vs. tenant work scope
- ☐ Record any landlord control rights over TI construction
- ☐ Note TI claw-back provisions if tenant vacates early

Section 6 - Options (Renewal, Expansion, Termination)

- ☐ List all renewal options: number of terms, notice period, new rent formula
- ☐ List all expansion options: space, timing, notice, rent terms
- ☐ List any right of first offer or right of first refusal and trigger conditions
- ☐ Extract termination option: date, penalty formula (unamortized costs + additional), notice
- ☐ Confirm whether options are personal to named tenant and survive assignment
- ☐ Note any conditions precedent (must not be in default, must be occupying, etc.)

Section 7 - Use, Exclusivity & Parking

- ☐ Extract permitted use clause verbatim
- ☐ Identify any exclusive use provision benefiting the tenant
- ☐ Identify any exclusive use provision restricting the tenant (check co-tenants)
- ☐ Note prohibited uses and hours of operation requirements
- ☐ Extract parking ratio, reserved spaces, and monthly parking cost if applicable

Section 8 - Assignment & Subletting

- ☐ Note whether landlord consent is required and any deemed-consent period
- ☐ Identify recapture rights and whether landlord shares in profit
- ☐ Confirm transfer to affiliates/parent: is it a "permitted transfer"?
- ☐ Note any change-of-control provision that triggers assignment consent

Section 9 - Insurance & Indemnity

- ☐ Extract tenant's required commercial general liability coverage limit
- ☐ Note additional insured requirements and waiver of subrogation
- ☐ Confirm property insurance obligations and who insures tenant improvements
- ☐ Identify any indemnification obligations beyond standard mutual indemnity

Section 10 - Default & Remedies

- ☐ Record monetary default cure period (days after notice)
- ☐ Record non-monetary default cure period (days, plus extended cure for complex repairs)
- ☐ Identify any self-help rights for tenant if landlord fails to make repairs
- ☐ Note landlord's remedies at law and any limitation on consequential damages
- ☐ Confirm notice requirements: written, certified mail, to whom

Section 11 - Special Provisions & Red Flags

- ☐ Flag any co-tenancy clause (anchor tenant, occupancy %, remedy)
- ☐ Flag any force majeure clause that could excuse rent or extend term
- ☐ Note any SNDA status: signed, recorded, in negotiation
- ☐ Identify any construction, expansion, or major renovation rights for landlord
- ☐ Flag any rooftop, signage, or antenna rights
- ☐ Confirm governing law and venue for dispute resolution

Quality Control Pass - Source Verification

- ☐ For every economic field, record the exact page and section reference used as the source of truth
- ☐ Compare base lease values against every amendment and use the latest controlling provision
- ☐ Mark any inferred value as review-required; do not present calculations as verbatim lease text
- ☐ Separate current obligations from historical obligations that expired before the review date
- ☐ Confirm all defined terms used in the source clause are traced back to their definitions
- ☐ Flag any value that appears in an exhibit but conflicts with the body of the lease

Field-Level Review Notes

- ☐ Dates: verify whether deadlines run from expiration, commencement, rent commencement, or fiscal year end
- ☐ Rent: capture both monthly dollar amount and annual per-square-foot economics when both are available
- ☐ CAM: split estimated payments, reconciled actuals, exclusions, caps, and audit rights into separate fields
- ☐ Options: calculate notice deadlines backward and note the required delivery method
- ☐ Insurance: separate coverage limits from endorsement requirements and waiver obligations
- ☐ Assignment: distinguish ordinary consent rights from affiliate transfers, mergers, and change of control

Confidence Tags to Apply

- ☐ High confidence: value appears clearly in one controlling clause and all amendments agree
- ☐ Medium confidence: value is present but requires a cross-reference, calculation, or amendment comparison
- ☐ Low confidence: value is missing, ambiguous, contradicted, handwritten, or sourced from degraded scan text

Red Flag Review - CAM & Operating Expenses

- ☐ No audit rights or audit window shorter than 90 days after reconciliation delivery
- ☐ Uncapped controllable operating expenses in a NNN or modified gross lease
- ☐ Management fee above 5%, applied to excluded expenses, or stacked with an admin fee
- ☐ Capital expenditures passed through immediately rather than amortized over useful life
- ☐ Gross-up provision missing, overly broad, or applied to non-variable costs

Red Flag Review - Business Terms

- ☐ Renewal option notice deadline already expired or less than 180 days away
- ☐ Holdover rent over 200% or holdover converts into a new fixed term
- ☐ Personal guaranty lacks cap, burn-down, or release tied to tenant performance
- ☐ Assignment clause gives landlord recapture rights or profit-sharing without affiliate carveout
- ☐ Exclusive use or co-tenancy clause can materially impair future operations or value

Final Abstraction Review

- ☐ Confirm every required field has a value, explicit 'not found', or low-confidence review note
- ☐ Spot-check at least 10 high-risk fields against the PDF before sharing the abstract
- ☐ Export a clean copy for business users and retain a source-reference copy for audit trail

How Lextract automates this checklist in 5-15 minutes

-  Upload your lease PDF - Lextract extracts all 126 fields into structured review output
-  Every item on this checklist is extracted, validated, and scored for confidence
-  Export to PDF or CSV, share with your team

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